

WORDPRESS

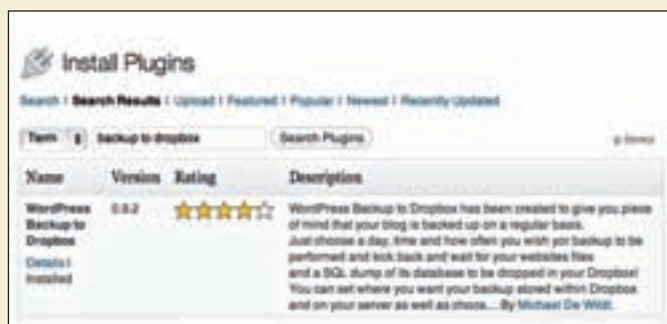
We take a close look at WordPress, the blogging world's most trusted publishing tool and try to unlock some of its hidden mysteries to help you blog better and smarter. Please note that all the WordPress plug-ins mentioned here can be found in the plug-ins directory at <http://www.wordpress.org>

Automatically backup to Dropbox

When you start blogging regularly and accumulate a fair number of posts and followers, it's advisable to take regular backups of your blogging software and post database to help you on a rainy day. Usually, if your blog is hosted on a reputed web host, they always schedule regular backups; but getting a copy of your site's latest backup from the web host can be a cumbersome and time-consuming process. This has an adverse effect on traffic and followers.

To avoid this doomsday scenario, it's good practice to take manual backups of your blog from time to time. And what better way than to automate the task? This is where Dropbox comes in, if you didn't already know, it is a leading cloud storage and file sharing service.

Go to WordPress.org and search for the "WordPress Backup To Dropbox" plug-in. Download and install the plug-in in your WordPress installation directory.



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{ Tips & Tricks has its own page numbers, and does not follow the rest of the magazine's page numbers. This is done to ensure that you can cut out and save T&T in a separate folder for later reference. }

After installation, check under Settings > Backup to Dropbox to setup the backup process. At one stage, the plug-in asks to authorise itself with Dropbox. In a new window that pops up you must authenticate this plug-in to access your Dropbox account (you need to have a registered Dropbox account at this stage). After you grant access, the plug-in continues to set up your WordPress installation's backup. The plug-in uses OAuth, so don't worry, your Dropbox login details are safe.

Just choose a day, time and the frequency of backup to be performed, and that's it. The



Jetpack is one powerful plug-in which comes with extra plug-ins

plug-in ensures your web site's files and an SQL dump of its database is backed up to Dropbox on the specified time and date. You can set where you want your backup stored within Dropbox and on your server as well as choose what files or directories, if any, you wish to exclude from the backup. For more details, checkout the web site: <http://wpb2d.com>

Get WordPress.com features for your custom blog

If you've ever opened a WordPress.com account, you know of the kind of professional, pre-loaded settings and services it comes with compared

to the vanilla WordPress.org CMS installed on your blog. For this, you need to download and install Jetpack by WordPress.com from the plug-in directory. And trust us, you'll be glad you installed this particular plug-in.

So what does Jetpack come with? A whole lot of features that would otherwise require a multitude of plug-ins from the WordPress.org directory. And some of Jetpack's features are exclusive and, difficult to find elsewhere. Here's what it does.

Jetpack gives you the ability to mark up your posts with the markup language- perfect for complex mathematical equations and other über-geekery,

which you otherwise can't implement within your blog posts. It gives you the added options of extra sidebar widgets for Twitter and RSS links. Jetpack even takes away the hassle of broadcasting your blog's content to the outside world, implementing a one-click approach to submitting your latest posts to search engines and other services in real-time.

This plug-in also comes with the most basic features- social sharing buttons next to every post and page- to advanced features like real-time stats and analytics of visitors stopping by your web site. Embedding videos from YouTube, Vimeo and others sites you can get a unique short